

NRI REMITTANCES

Dollar DREAMS

India's 2.5-million-strong migrant population has not only provided a better living standard to families back home but also ensured that India's forex registers keep ringing

■ By Malini Bhupta

It's been 10 years since Bhupinder Kaur met her husband Chamanlal. But she does not regret the separation because ever since he moved to New York, USA, life has not been the same for Kaur and her two children—Karandeep, 19, and Inayat, 14—who live in Jalandhar. Before moving abroad, her husband earned a paltry Rs 4,000 as an insurance agent. She could not even dream of sending their two children to international schools or trav-

elling by car. But with remittances of Rs 30,000 a month coming from the US, she and her children lack nothing. Kaur says, "Yes, I do miss my husband but he went for our sake. Since the time he has been working there, I am able to give the best education to my children and even think of buying a house."

Like Chamanlal, India's 2.5-million-strong migrant population—mostly blue-collar workers—have not only provided a better living standard to

REUBEN SINGH

MOOLAH RULES: Bhupinder at a Western Union counter in Jalandhar

